

Dev Chandra Patel | San Francisco, CA
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SUMMARY

Nuclear engineer turned AI-native founder: Co-Founder & CEO of Startup Intros (\$300K pre-seed, 26K+ subscriber community) and Navy Reserve Engineering Officer with a Carnegie Mellon MBA. Decade of leading high-stakes, cross-functional programs, from managing naval warship construction and maintenance to building AI-first growth, content, and operations systems from zero, especially at the early stage.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & CEO (Entrepreneur in Residence), Startup Intros, San Francisco, CA MAR 2025 – Present

- Incubated Startup Intros at Context Ventures and raised \$300K pre-seed round from Context Ventures
- Built the app and community connecting founders, investors, and operators through introductions, events, content, and data-driven investor discovery.
- Grew distribution to 26K+ email subscribers (100+ newsletters at ~45% open rates), 8K LinkedIn followers, and 2.6K X followers using AI-assisted content and distribution workflows.
- Hosted 30+ events, including pitch nights, panels, live podcasts, founder dinners, and coffee meetups, collaborating with Startup Grind, Notion, Mercury, Perkins Coie, VCs, and other event organizers.
- Developed founder and investor data infrastructure, including funding-round datasets, curated investor lists, startup program databases, lead workflows, and internal research systems for investor discovery.
- Managed company operations spanning legal, finance, cap table materials, partnerships, and brand assets, implementing AI systems for content production, outreach, and knowledge management.

AI Automation Consultant, Dev Chandra Consulting, Self-Employed MAR 2020 – MAR 2025

- Designed and deployed custom AI automation systems and workflows, enabling small businesses to reduce manual tasks and improve operational efficiency without hiring extra people.
- Developed and implemented AI-driven strategies for lead nurturing, content management, project management, client onboarding, and more to enhance scalability.
- Generated affiliate revenue on the company's "[The Process Hacker](#)" blog by publishing regular articles on business management, business operations, productivity, habits, and goal setting.

Engineering Duty Officer (LCDR), US Navy Reserves, Alameda, CA AUG 2021 – Present

- Serves as Executive Officer, leading 30+ Sailors for an engineering unit that supports submarine maintenance and repair operations at Pearl Harbor Naval Shipyard.
- Led a team of 8 Sailors for DEPLOYEX San Diego, ensuring mobilization readiness and alignment for the USS SCRANTON (SSN-756) maintenance availability.
- Qualified Engineering Duty Officer (1445) within 18 months of transferring to the Navy Reserve.

Lead Engineer & Associate, Booz Allen Hamilton, Norfolk, VA AUG 2023 – SEP 2024

- Served as the Shipyard and Engineering Duty SME, supporting the Submarine Maintenance Operations Center (SMOC) at Submarine Forces, Atlantic (SUBLANT).
- Led the BAH data team with project management in JIRA to develop over 10 Qlik/Jupiter dashboards to track submarine availability, operational status, maintenance schedules, and material readiness.
- Provided technical expertise and support in weekly Flag and executive-level meetings, overseeing submarine maintenance, modernization, and planning at naval shipyards nationwide.

- Prepared and delivered detailed shipyard and submarine readiness briefs for SMOC leadership, ensuring informed decision-making and strategic planning.

Government Affairs Liaison, NAVSEA 08 (Naval Reactors), Washington, DC JUL 2018 – JUL 2021

- Organized presentations, briefings, tours, and meals to maintain relationships with 150+ Congressional offices and agencies in the DOD and DOE to communicate priorities and issues for the US Navy.
- Authored an annual 300+ page research document of Navy reports, budget documents, and anticipated questions to prepare the 4-Star Admiral to testify for the agency's \$1.65B+ budget at Congress.
- Authored biweekly briefings for the 4-Star Admiral and senior officials to provide information, analysis, and recommendations regarding legislation and actions from Congress that concern the Navy and DOE.
- Drafted and compiled 50+ formal responses, reports, and comments amongst various Navy and DOE organizations to respond to inquiries and requests from Congressional committees and offices.

Fellow, Project on Nuclear Issues, Center for Strategic & International Studies NOV 2018 – APR 2020

- Studied and discussed the policy, technical, and operational aspects of nuclear weapons and security.
- Published an [article](#) that evaluates the defensive effectiveness of India's nuclear submarine fleet.

Nuclear Engineering Project Manager, NAVSEA 08 (Naval Reactors), Washington APR 2017 – JUL 2018

- Managed the schedule, operations, and technical support amongst DOE laboratories, prime contractors, and private shipyards for the nuclear reactor assembly project for the new construction aircraft carrier.
- Directed 50+ EPC contractors to transport and assemble nuclear components for two A1B nuclear reactors, which would later be craned into the USS JOHN F. KENNEDY (CVN 79) construction project.
- Reviewed and approved laboratory and shipyard recommendations for technical, shipping and handling, and process improvements to resolve nuclear safety issues, avoid delays, and raise workflow efficiency.
- Supported regulatory oversight of the nuclear modernization project as part of a larger 3-year, mid-life renovations for an aircraft carrier, USS GEORGE WASHINGTON (CVN 73).

Nuclear Engineering Manager, NAVSEA 08 (Naval Reactors), Washington, DC SEP 2016 – APR 2017

- Reviewed design drawings, led site surveys, performed safety reviews, and identified critical path risk activities to support EPC contractors in managing and operating a DOE nuclear fuel processing facility.
- Developed and approved a unique remediation strategy for mitigating unplanned safety concerns for several contaminated shipping containers holding nuclear fuel from a decommissioned aircraft carrier.
- Evaluated and authorized security requirements for the dismantling and disposal of two submarines.

Materials Engineer, NAVSEA 08 (Naval Reactors), Washington, DC SEP 2015 – SEP 2016

- Analyzed and approved 1000+ pages of material science data for lab manuals for future warship designs.
- Revised instructional manuals and procurement specifications for designing longer-lasting warships.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Master of Business Administration (3.82 GPA), Carnegie Mellon University MAY 2023

Master of Engineering, Nuclear Engineering (3.81 GPA), Pennsylvania State University AUG 2019

Bachelor of Science, Mechanical Engineering (3.71 GPA), Johns Hopkins University MAY 2015

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

AI & Software: ChatGPT Codex, Claude, Cursor, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Google Cloud, Notion

Security Clearance: Active US Government DoD TS (SCI Eligible) Security Clearance